



640 x 480, 320 x 240, 160 x 120 and 128 x 160.

There are also three quality settings—fine, normal and basic. Other features include three white balance settings, and the capability to click a self-portrait using the external screen.

Strangely enough, both the internal and external screens are in use with the backlight on. This means that battery power gets drained faster—there is no option in the menu to switch off the external screen.

While talking on the phone, calls get terminated once the signal gets weak. This is probably the biggest shortcoming on this phone. In addition, the phone, in our tests, kept losing signal strength in areas where other phones were working.

The ring volume is very low, even when set to maximum. The vibrator is decent but not effective if the phone is being carried in a loose pocket or in a purse. This will probably result in many a missed call, especially while travelling.

Motorola C650

Price: Rs 10,495 A-

Weighing just 91grams and boasting of features such as MPEG4 playback, WAP, GPRS, Java games and a VGA camera, the price of Rs 10,495 for the Motorola C650 is justified.

The C650 sports a comfortable keypad layout. Typing messages is fast using the T9 method. There's also the Cut, Copy and Paste feature, so there's no need to re-type recurring words in a message.



The screen offers four lines of text. However, it can only accommodate two words per line; and if a word is 12 letters or longer, it displays just one word per line. To add to the problem, the screen is not readable in daylight, even with the backlight on.

The VGA camera offers 4X digital zoom. The screen size is 128 x 128, and supports 65K colours. The images, however, don't look all that great, and you get the feeling you're looking at a 4K colour screen.

You can assign photos to phonebook contacts, and also have an MP3 track as a ringtone.

The phone has a USB interface, which makes connecting the phone to a system and installing it as simple as installing any other USB-based peripheral. Once installation is done, the phone is detected as a USB modem. You can then dial a number, send and receive e-mail, read messages from the Inbox, etc, from and on the PC.

Sony Ericsson T610

Price: Rs 19,900 C+

This little beauty, exclusively crafted by Erik Ahlgren, a senior industrial designer of Sony Ericsson, is targeted at those who want to make a fashion statement. The crystal-clear 64K colour screen ensures perfect readability. Since this is not a TFT screen,

readability is affected in the Sun, but is still quite readable. Planning to buy a new colour phone with loads of features at a reasonable price? Look no further!

With respect to voice quality, even at the weakest signal strength, voice was astoundingly clear. While on the move, especially in trains, the voice does drop, but this could be related to the network.

The address book allows you to store 510 numbers with 8 different entries each. This phone doesn't allow you to view SIM and phone data simultaneously, unlike the newer set of phones.

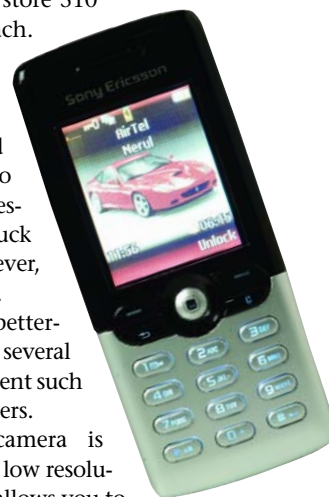
The text messages can be printed via a Bluetooth connection, and also saved to the SIM. Support for long messages is also provided, so you're not stuck with a limit of 160 characters. However, the 'send To many' feature is missing.

The MMS editor is one of the better-implemented tools we've seen across several phones. It also allows blocking of content such as advertisements and anonymous users.

The image quality of the camera is no great shakes, obviously due to the low resolution. A tiny mirror in the back panel allows you to take your own picture. The phone allows you to store a little over 2 MB of data, if you remove the predefined set of items. Most people consider this to be too less, but then, there are already a couple of games bundled; Sony Ericsson allows you to store images on their servers; there's static memory for the phone; and there are SMS and voice tags. So, 2 MB should be enough for most users.

Battery life is about three days, or not more than 5 days with minimal use.

About all the talk about 'Quick Share'—this is nothing but a marketing gimmick, based upon the idea that the phone provides connectivity options such as Bluetooth, infrared and cable.



BenQ S670C

Price: Rs 13,490 B-

The clamshell BenQ S670C is good value for money at Rs 13,490. Advertised as a phone with morphing features, the S670C comes with more than just that.

The upper flap is coated with a jazzy-looking material that breaks out of the monotonous plastic-look mould. A small OLED display on the upper flap rotates the time with a nice scrolling wallpaper. The body has a chiselled look, except for the jutting antenna.

Flipping open the phone reveals a 65K colour screen that is relatively sharp compared to other BenQ models. Menu browsing is via a jog dial and two soft-keys. The buttons offer the right tactile feedback and are fun to use. The dial pad is well spaced. SMSing does leave your fingers tired, since the keys are arranged in a curve.

The menu is simple to navigate, and is intuitive enough to get hold of in the first go. The VGA camera is placed at the

